5. Which island is expected to be hit on Saturday?

DO YOU KNOW?

HudHud cyclone is named after a bird Hoopoe. It is an exotic creature widespread in Asia and North Africa.

b. Read the following report on the precautionary steps taken during Cyclone Hudhud.



1. Disasters are inevitable but happen unexpectedly. While all disasters may not be the necessary results of unfortunate natural events, more often they occur when these events intersect with a vulnerable human environment, Particularly, inappropriate location of settlements, inadequate infrastructural development and lack of capacity building of communities to deal with natural events or dangers lead to disasters. Since the ability of the human environment to withstand the impacts of danger plays a direct role in the number of casualties and monetary costs of disasters, it is important to reduce the vulnerabilities within the environment and enhance its capacity for disaster mitigation and reconstruction if we are to be resilient in the face of disasters.

Why do disasters end up hazardous at times?

2. India with a coastline of 7516 km is vulnerable to cyclones of varying intensities. HUDHUD a Very Severe Cyclonic Storm (VSCS), hit the east coast at Vishakhapatnam on 12th Oct, 2014. Although it was not the most severe cyclone to hit the Indian coast, it has been the most devastating one in recent times to make landfall in an urban area. Its 'eye', lay exactly over the city, causing tremendous loss to life, property and natural resources. Although human causalities were relatively low, there was a tremendous loss of livelihood in the affected areas. About 1,12,850 houses were partially or fully damaged in the coastal areas of Vishakhapatnam district alone. The fact that loss of human life was low can be attributed to the sustained preparedness and mitigation measures undertaken in the past, and effective and timely response initiated by the Central and State Government(s), right from the early warning stage.

- When and where did Hudhud hit severely?
- "Human casualties were restricted to the minimum." How?

3. The steps for effective preparedness measures which need to be taken by the State Governments and District Administrations in order to mitigate the effects of cyclone are:

a) Appropriate advisory should be issued for removal of signboards, hoardings etc. which are prone to fall when strong winds strike and cause damage to life and property.

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